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Big changes to loans may upend terms for higher ed

Will they ease debt load or make it harder to attend?

By Diti Kohli and Mara Kardas-Nelson
GLOBE STAFF

For decades, the federal government has pumped trillions into student loans, helping millions of Americans go to college.

Now, in the most far-reaching changes in a generation, Washington has tempered its largesse.

Through a combination of cuts to loan programs and new caps on borrowing by graduate students, the Trump administration is scaling back the assistance many families tap to bridge the ever-rising costs of college. With nearly 8 million borrowers already in default, the White House believes the moves will help rein in the nation's student debt crisis and pressure schools to lower tuition.

The changes take effect in July, leaving students and universities alike scrambling to nail down funding for the next academic year.

The Plus loan program for graduate schools has been eliminated outright, as have multiple low-

STUDENT LOANS, Page A13



TYGER WILLIAMS/PHILADELPHIA INQUIRER

Excitement was high in Philadelphia as fans watched the second round of draws in December.

In World Cup tilt, Philly has the edge

Rival host crushing Boston on match prep

By Chris Serres and Michael Silverman
GLOBE STAFF

PHILADELPHIA — At the heart of this city's Fashion District, volunteers in crisp new FIFA World Cup uniforms sashayed down a carpeted runway last month, enveloped by cheers and flashing cameras. Throngs of soccer fans pressed toward the catwalk — waving, screaming, reaching out — in an event designed to mimic the spectacle of a Paris fashion show.

The previous afternoon, on a hilltop overlooking Philadelphia's skyline, members of the city's host committee served up cocktails flavored with citrus and tarragon to the foreign press touring the future site of the city's World Cup fan festival. Costumed impersonators of Ben Franklin and Betsy Ross mingled with journalists from Morocco, Spain, and England, who remarked on the beauty of the site.

All over town, from Lincoln Financial Field to busy Schuylkill Expressway, there are billboards and colorful signs heralding

PHILADELPHIA, Page A17

A succession battle worthy of Wall Street over the 527-foot crossing to Chappaquiddick

By Mike Damiano | GLOBE STAFF



FINN GOMEZ FOR THE BOSTON GLOBE

Ferry captains Moss Xiques and Brock Callen took vehicles to Chappaquiddick aboard the On Time III.

EDGARTOWN — The homeowners of Chappaquiddick Island are used to getting their way. They have launched companies, sued governments, and invested the assets of generational fortunes. One, a private equity titan, spent an untold sum to lift up and move his mansion hundreds of feet from the edge of an eroding cliff.

But recently they have met an immovable force: Peter Wells, a Santa Claus-looking man who controls access to their homes.

Wells is the longtime owner-operator of the Chappaquiddick Ferry — the sole means of getting to and from the island. And residents have long chafed at his control.

Now, with his retirement imminent, Wells is looking to sell, which has set off a succession drama pitting Chappaquiddick's lawyers and financiers against Wells, his ferry captains, and the small-town government that is technically in charge. Soon, the Edgartown Select Board will have to vote to approve or deny the sale.

A grassy, sandy spit of land, Chappaquiddick contains a few dozen mansions, a few hundred less palatial homes, the bridge that some locals grimly call the Kennedy car wash, and not much else. It is an island off an island, separated from "mainland" Martha's Vineyard by 527 feet of ocean known as the Chappaquiddick Channel.

And the only way across — for residents and summer tourists alike — is through Wells.

CHAPPAQUIDDICK, Page A14

By any other name, they're still timeout rooms for school kids

By Mariana Simões
GLOBE STAFF

Some schools call it the calm down room. Or the safe space. Or even the Zen den.

Across Massachusetts, schools use dozens of different, cozy-sounding names to describe what can be closet-sized timeout rooms where students are placed to curb behavioral outbursts.

Advocates for students with disabilities know these euphemisms well, from the chill room to the regulation station, the emotional

reset space to the self-management room. But parents don't necessarily understand what educators mean when they learn their child spent time in the thinking room.

A positive name for a timeout room "keeps parents from looking deeper," said Kathy Trainor, a mother who has been a special education advocate for more than a decade.

Trainor gathered a list of 45 different terms used by schools across the Commonwealth. The

TIMEOUTS, Page A13

Manchester, N.H., is the site of two Frank Lloyd Wright homes; the Currier Museum of Art is ready to show them off. **N11.**

She was a rising star in Massachusetts politics; four years later she was chanting "Death to America." **Globe Magazine.**

Bud seriously

Sunday: Clouds then sun. High: 68-73. Low: 49-54.

Monday: Rainy, cooler. Complete report, **A24.** Deaths, **A18-23.**

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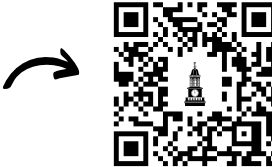
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